

Flyovers and congestion

What has been shown about journey time, air pollution and noise?

THE CLAIM

“reduce delays, emissions, and noise pollution”

Infrastructure Malta, Msida Creek statement, 28 October 2024

Marsa complete · Msida flyover open; wider project works continue

The Marsa percentages are agency-reported. The survey files were not found in the public record reviewed.

VERDICT

NOT SUBSTANTIATED

*Plausible benefits;
data not inspectable.*

SUPPORTED

LARGELY
SUPPORTED

NOT
SUBSTANTIATED

MISLEADING

CONTRADICTED

MAIN RESULTS

79%

Marsa travel-time reduction

Reported by Infrastructure Malta in its 2021 completion release; underlying survey not linked.

Up to 70%

Marsa PM emissions reduction

Agency-reported estimate; not the same as a measured change in ambient air concentrations.

2024

Msida wording was a forecast

IM said the flyover would reduce delays, emissions and noise; the flyover entered use in December 2025.

No series

Local noise results

No comparable before-and-after noise measurements were located for either junction.

Open

What would verify the claim

Publish the traffic surveys, calculation methods and local air/noise measurements.

FAIR TO SAY

Flyovers can reduce stops for particular movements, and Infrastructure Malta reports benefits at Marsa. The public materials reviewed do not include the underlying surveys; Msida's wider project was still underway.

WHAT WOULD SETTLE IT

- ☐ Publish the Marsa survey files and methods.
- ☐ Separate emissions estimates from ambient air-monitor readings.
- ☐ Measure traffic, air and noise after Msida's full road layout is operating.
- ☐ Track local and network effects over several years.